core of turning around that economy from being a narcoeconomy into an economy as we know it.

Ms. Ros-Lehtinen. I am going to interrupt you there, General, just to see if I can sneak in a quick question about new troops, new military assistance to Afghanistan, a fresh deployment of about 1,000 troops. How meaningful are these new deployments and commitments?

General Jones. The overall request by NATO standards is modest, and it has always been modest. It has been in the thousands of troops. It has been additional helicopters, mobility assets, communications, intelligence gathering and the things. But if you rack it and stack it, it is modest. And it was modest 2 years ago, it still remains modest. And if—for the life of me I do not know why it is that we seem to have so much trouble providing those troops.

But I want to state that despite that, the overall problems that we need to address are not more military troops. I think you could put 10,000 more troops in there and you would still have the same problems. If you do not address the civil sector reform, if we do not hold the Karzai government to metrics——

Ms. Ros-Lehtinen. Thank you.

General Jones [continuing]. That are deliverable we are going to continue to mark time.

Ms. Ros-Lehtinen. Correct. Thank you, sirs.

Chairman Berman. The time of the gentlelady has expired. The gentlelady from Texas, Ms. Sheila Jackson Lee, is recognized for 5 minutes.

Ms. Jackson Lee. I think this is one of the more important hearings that we will have an opportunity to participate in. I thank the chairman and the ranking member, and I thank the witnesses and appreciate the presence of *Ambassador Holbrooke* and *Ambassador Pickring* and *General Jones* waiting because we have had a difficult morning.

I co-chair the Pakistan Caucus and have the pleasure of cochairing with my colleagues the Afghan Caucus. And probably was one of the early members who went into Afghanistan in the early stages I believe was 2002. And really saw the rawness of Afghanistan. I think we were in before now President Karzai was elected, he was then Chairman Karzai, and we were in before the assassination had occurred in June of that year. In fact this country assisted, of course, with the security system that he had and was in place at that time.

To Ambassador Pickring and General Jones as well, I frankly have a different perspective. I am glad to hear *General Jones* saying 10,000 more troops or 20,000 more troops; we must work on the diplomatic infrastructure of Afghanistan. And I believe we must work on the people aspect of it which means the education of people, etc., etc.

And I like the statement let us find those or 50 percent of those poppy farmers and give them some alternative and let us see how it works. Some I am going to take you up on your offer.

I am also going to take you up on the offer, Ambassador Pickring, of some high-placed person that is focused only on Afghanistan. I do believe we have to win the war in Afghanistan but there are many principles to win it by. Likewise, decouple Afghanistan from Iraq. And, frankly, let me say it again and again: Bring the troops from Iraq. We have won that conflict in honor by the troops having done everything we asked them to do. It is now in the hands of the diplomats and a better Iraqi Government. And Maliki has to stand up and be counted on leading that country and he is not doing that.

But I want to go to Pakistan. I have a much more different attitude. I think we should applaud the PPP. And they are trying to work with Sharif. And, frankly, I believe that is more

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